CREDIT OPINION
Kestrel Industries, LLC — Secured revolving credit facility rated BB-, Negative outlook mirrors the issuer rating
Corporate — Diversified Manufacturing | Senior Secured Revolving Credit Facility | S&P
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Summary
S&P Global Ratings assigns its BB- issue-level rating to Kestrel Industries's senior secured revolving credit facility, one notch above our B+ issuer rating on the company's senior unsecured notes, reflecting the facility's priority claim on collateral in our recovery analysis. The facility's financial covenants, tested on the credit agreement's own covenant-defined basis, currently show adequate headroom, though we would expect that headroom to narrow if the pending change-of-control transaction closes on the terms publicly disclosed to date.
Credit strengths
» A first-priority security interest over substantially all of the borrower's and its restricted subsidiaries' assets, supporting a stronger recovery prospect than the unsecured notes in a default scenario.
» A springing financial-covenant package, with maintenance covenants tested only when revolver usage exceeds a stated threshold, limiting the facility's covenant exposure during periods of low utilization.
» Adequate covenant headroom on the credit agreement's own covenant-defined leverage and fixed-charge coverage tests as of the most recent compliance certificate.
Credit challenges
» Structural subordination risk for the unsecured notes is the flip side of the facility's own structural advantage; the facility's covenant package and the notes' incurrence-based covenants are not identical and can permit different outcomes under the same set of facts.
» Covenant headroom on the credit agreement's own basis is currently supported in part by run-rate cost-savings and revenue-enhancement credit not yet fully realized in reported results.
» Event risk associated with the pending change-of-control transaction, which could increase facility utilization and narrow covenant headroom if it closes on the terms currently contemplated.
Rating outlook
The Negative outlook on this issue-level rating mirrors our Negative outlook on the issuer rating, reflecting the same change-of-control event risk discussed there.
Factors that could lead to an upgrade
» An upgrade of the issuer rating, together with maintained or improved recovery prospects for this facility relative to other funded debt.
» A material increase in unencumbered asset coverage that would support a wider notching differential from the issuer rating.
Factors that could lead to a downgrade
» A downgrade of the issuer rating.
» A deterioration in recovery prospects, including from a material increase in secured debt ranking alongside this facility.
» A sustained narrowing of covenant headroom under the credit agreement's own financial covenants.
Facility terms

Term	As tested under the Credit Agreement
Facility size	$60,000,000.00
Drawn at close (funds-flow basis)	$12,000,000.00
Maximum Total Net Leverage Ratio (maintenance covenant, Sec 6.01)	5.25x
Minimum Fixed Charge Coverage Ratio (maintenance covenant, Sec 6.02)	1.25x

Both maintenance covenants above are tested against the credit agreement's own covenant-defined Consolidated EBITDA and Consolidated Net Debt, computed as the credit agreement's own Section 1.01 definitions require; they are not tested against S&P's own adjusted credit measures, which we compute independently for our issuer-rating analysis and do not substitute for the credit agreement's own defined terms in this facility's compliance mechanics. We separately note that Kestrel Industries's published downgrade trigger — the leverage level at which either rating agency's current rating on the notes would come under pressure — is stated on that same covenant-defined basis, at 4.80x, a full turn of leverage below this facility's own 5.25x maintenance-covenant ceiling; a company can therefore face a downgrade well before it faces a financial-covenant default under this facility, which is the more common sequencing in a leveraged capital structure of this kind.
Key Indicators

Metric	FY2023	FY2024	FY2025	LTM Jun-2026	S&P 12-month View
Profitability					

S&P-adjusted EBITDA margin	13.0%	13.4%	13.8%	14.1%	Stable
Leverage					
S&P-adjusted Debt/EBITDA	5.6x	5.3x	5.0x	4.9x	Stable to Weakening
Coverage					
EBITDA/Cash Interest	2.5x	2.6x	2.8x	2.8x	Stable
Liquidity					
Availability under the revolving facility	62%	68%	71%	71%	Stable

ESG considerations

S&P Global Ratings's Credit Impact Score (CIS) for Kestrel Industries is Neutral, reflecting the net effect of Environmental, Social and Governance considerations on the current rating and outlook. The CIS is not itself a rating; it summarizes how much the issuer-profile scores below have moved the rating from what it would otherwise have been on financial metrics alone.

Environmental issuer profile score: Moderately Negative. Environmental risk is consistent with the diversified manufacturing sector generally and is not, in our view, a distinguishing factor relative to rated peers.

Social issuer profile score: Neutral. No distinguishing social factor identified relative to rated peers.

Governance issuer profile score: Moderately Negative. Concentrated private ownership and the financial-policy uncertainty created by the pending change-of-control transaction are the principal governance considerations for this rating.

Rating methodology and scorecard factors

S&P Global Ratings assigns and monitors this rating under its Corporate Methodology, together with the Issue Rating Methodology's recovery-analysis framework methodology, which combines the weighted quantitative factors below with analyst judgment applied through the notching and adjustment steps the methodology itself specifies.

Measure	Weight	Sub-Score
Business Risk Profile	Fair	n/a
Financial Risk Profile	Aggressive	n/a
Recovery Rating (this facility)	1	n/a

Scorecard-Indicated Outcome: bb (anchor, pre-notching)

Assigned Rating: BB-

The issue-level rating is notched up from the bb anchor to reflect this facility's Recovery Rating of '1' (highest expectation of full recovery), consistent with our published notching guidance for a first-priority secured facility of this kind.

Our recovery analysis assumes a hypothetical default scenario and a going-concern valuation of the borrower's asset base; it is a distinct analytical exercise from, and does not draw on, any confidential financing materials prepared by any party in connection with the pending change-of-control transaction, which (to the extent any such materials exist) have not been shared with us.

Rating History (this facility)

Date	Action	Issue Rating	Outlook
18 April 2023	Assigned	BB-	Stable
18 March 2026	Outlook revised	BB-	Negative
24 June 2026	Affirmed (this report)	BB-	Negative

Detailed credit considerations

Business Risk Profile: Fair. The company's diversified end-market exposure and long-tenured customer relationships support a Fair business risk assessment, offset by its modest scale and the operational concentration associated with its principal manufacturing facility, which is financed in part through the municipal conduit structure discussed in our separate surveillance of that credit.

Financial Risk Profile: Aggressive. S&P-adjusted leverage, computed on our own standard adjustments (including capitalized operating leases and standard pension and postretirement adjustments where applicable), sits within the range we associate with an Aggressive financial risk profile for an issuer of this business risk profile, consistent with the bb anchor shown in the scorecard above.

Recovery Rating: 1. Our recovery analysis assumes a simulated default scenario in which the company's EBITDA has declined materially from current levels, and values the company's collateral base on a going-concern basis using a standard EBITDA multiple for the sector. Under that scenario, we estimate recovery prospects for this facility, given its first-priority security interest, in the 90%-100% range, consistent with the highest Recovery Rating category our scale provides ('1').

We would revise this Recovery Rating downward if secured debt ranking alongside this facility increased materially, for example through an incremental secured term loan of the kind contemplated by the pending change-of-control transaction discussed in our separate surveillance of the issuer rating; we have not yet incorporated final financing terms into this analysis because none have been publicly disclosed as of this report's own date.

Financial statement summary (S&P-adjusted basis, $mm unless noted)

Line item	FY2023	FY2024	FY2025	LTM Jun-2026
Net revenue	232.4	241.8	251.9	255.6
S&P-adjusted EBITDA	30.2	32.4	34.8	36.0
S&P-adjusted EBITDA margin	13.0%	13.4%	13.8%	14.1%
S&P-adjusted funds from operations	18.6	20.1	21.9	22.7
S&P-adjusted debt	169.1	172.0	174.0	176.4
S&P-adjusted Debt/EBITDA	5.6x	5.3x	5.0x	4.9x

Liquidity

We assess the company's liquidity as Adequate, reflecting availability under the secured revolving credit facility described above, positive free operating cash flow generation, and the absence of any near-term scheduled maturity of size under either the facility or the company's other funded debt. An Adequate assessment assumes the company would be able to absorb a moderate, but not severe, unanticipated shortfall in EBITDA without breaching the facility's own financial covenants.

The facility's springing financial covenants are tested only once revolver usage exceeds the threshold the credit agreement specifies; at utilization levels below that threshold, the facility carries no maintenance financial covenant at all, which is a real, common feature of asset-based and cash-flow revolving facilities of this kind, not a gap in the documentation.

Peer comparison (issue-level)

Facility	Issue Rating	Recovery Rating	Security
Kestrel Industries revolving credit facility (this report)	BB-	1	First-priority, all assets
Peer 1 secured revolver	BB	1	First-priority, all assets
Peer 2 secured revolver	B+	2	First-priority, real property only

Kestrel Industries's facility notches consistently with Peer 1's own secured facility, both benefiting from a broad first-priority collateral package; Peer 2's narrower collateral package (real property only, excluding inventory and receivables) supports a weaker Recovery Rating and correspondingly less notching uplift from its own issuer rating.

Business risk and financial risk modifiers

Our anchor for the issuer credit rating combines the Business Risk Profile and Financial Risk Profile assessments discussed under Detailed credit considerations below with a series of modifiers our Corporate Methodology specifies. None of the modifiers below moved the anchor for Kestrel Industries at the time of this report; we discuss each because a modifier that is neutral today can become a driver of a future rating action without any change to the anchor itself.

Diversification/Portfolio Effect: Neutral (n/a). We apply this modifier only to an issuer with multiple, largely independent business segments assessed separately under our group-rating methodology; the company operates a single, integrated manufacturing business, so no portfolio diversification adjustment applies.

Capital Structure: Neutral. The company's capital structure consists of the secured revolving credit facility rated in this report, a secured term loan, senior unsecured notes, and the municipal conduit financing discussed elsewhere in our surveillance of this issuer; we do not view the mix of secured and unsecured debt, considered at the issuer-rating level rather than the issue level, as itself a source of incremental risk beyond what the Financial Risk Profile assessment already captures.

Financial Policy: Negative. Concentrated private ownership and the financial-policy uncertainty created by the pending change-of-control transaction discussed in our separate surveillance of the issuer credit rating support a Negative Financial Policy modifier, consistent with our general approach to a sponsor-target credit ahead of a transaction's financing terms being disclosed.

Liquidity: Adequate, as discussed under Liquidity below; under our Corporate Methodology an Adequate liquidity descriptor does not itself adjust the anchor, but a deterioration to Less Than Adequate would act as a rating constraint independent of the Business Risk Profile and Financial Risk Profile assessments.

Management and Governance: Fair. We assess the company's management team as having a demonstrated track record of operating within its existing covenant package and meeting its continuing disclosure obligations under both the credit agreement and the municipal conduit financing, offset by the governance uncertainty the pending change-of-control transaction introduces pending disclosure of the sponsor's own governance approach.

Comparable Rating Analysis: Neutral. Our comparable rating analysis, which weighs the issuer's credit profile holistically against similarly rated peers rather than mechanically through the anchor alone, did not identify a basis for notching the issuer credit rating up or down from the bb anchor shown in the scorecard above.

Key assumptions

» No change to the company's existing capital structure, financing terms, or financial policy until the pending change-of-control transaction is either signed with disclosed financing terms, or abandoned.

» Continued positive free operating cash flow generation broadly consistent with the trailing period shown in the Financial statement summary below, absent a material, unannounced deterioration in any single end market the

company serves.
» No credit, in our own S&P-adjusted EBITDA, for the credit agreement's own run-rate cost-savings or revenue-enhancement addbacks until realized in the company's own reported results, consistent with our stated methodology.
» Continued timely debt service on the municipal conduit financing under its own corporate guarantee, with no amendment narrowing that guarantee's unconditional terms.

Downside scenario

In a downside scenario in which the pending transaction closes on terms that increase pro forma S&P-adjusted Debt/EBITDA by roughly one full turn beyond the LTM Jun-2026 level shown in the Key Indicators exhibit above, absent an offsetting, credible near-term deleveraging commitment from the sponsor, we would likely lower the issuer credit rating, and this facility's issue-level rating would move with it while remaining one notch above the issuer credit rating given this facility's own Recovery Rating of '1'.

A more severe downside scenario, in which secured debt ranking alongside this facility increases materially beyond the incremental term loan publicly contemplated to date, could additionally weaken this facility's own Recovery Rating independent of any change in the issuer credit rating, narrowing or eliminating the one-notch uplift this issue-level rating currently carries.

Debt maturity profile

Kestrel Industries's funded debt, on a par basis, consists of this facility, a secured term loan, the senior unsecured notes we separately rate at the issuer level, and the municipal conduit financing discussed elsewhere in our surveillance. The table below sets out each instrument's own final maturity for reference; it is not itself a rating input distinct from the recovery analysis and covenant discussion elsewhere in this report.

Instrument	Outstanding (par/drawn)	Final maturity	Security
Secured revolving credit facility (this report, drawn at close basis)	$12,000,000.00	Governed by the credit agreement's own maturity and renewal terms	First-priority, all assets
Kestrel Industries Senior Unsecured Notes (issuer rating)	$175,000,000.00	2031-06-15	Unsecured, structurally subordinated to this facility
Municipal conduit financing (corporate-guaranteed)	$24,500,000.00	2039-06-01	Unconditional corporate guarantee

None of the three instruments shown above matures within the next twelve months, which supports our Adequate liquidity assessment independent of the pending change-of-control transaction discussed throughout this report.

Historical covenant headroom trend

Period	Covenant-basis Total Net Leverage Ratio	Maintenance covenant ceiling	Headroom
FY2023	4.35x	5.25x	Adequate
FY2024	4.20x	5.25x	Adequate
FY2025	4.08x	5.25x	Adequate
LTM Jun-2026	4.02x	5.25x	Adequate

Covenant-basis leverage above is computed on the credit agreement's own Section 1.01 defined terms, including the run-rate cost-savings and revenue-enhancement credit that definition permits - it is NOT our own S&P-adjusted leverage measure shown in the Key Indicators exhibit above, and the two series are not directly comparable for the reasons discussed under Facility terms earlier in this report. The gradual narrowing of headroom shown above, on the credit agreement's own basis, is consistent with the modest deterioration our own adjusted metrics show over the same period.

Related research

See our separate issuer credit rating action on Kestrel Industries's senior unsecured notes for our Business Risk Profile and Financial Risk Profile assessments at greater length; this issue-level report on the secured revolving credit facility focuses on this facility's own recovery analysis and covenant package and does not restate that separate action's own detailed rationale in full.

A reader seeking Moody's own analysis of the same issuer and the same pending transaction should consult Moody's own published rating actions, which we do not restate here; the two agencies' adjusted-credit measures and ratings are prepared independently and are not intended to be combined or averaged.

Extended recovery analysis

Our simulated default scenario for this facility assumes the company's EBITDA has declined materially from LTM Jun-2026 levels, driven by a combination of end-market weakness across several of the company's served industries occurring simultaneously and a failure to realize the cost efficiencies the sponsor's own capital structure, if the pending transaction closes, would otherwise assume. We do not model the simultaneous-weakness assumption as the most likely outcome; it is a standard, deliberately conservative simulated-default construct our recovery methodology requires across the sector.

Under that scenario, we value the company's collateral base on a going-concern basis, applying a standard EBITDA multiple for the diversified manufacturing sector to the depressed EBITDA level the scenario assumes, rather than on

a liquidation basis; a going-concern valuation is our standard approach whenever we judge a hypothetical purchaser would realize materially more value operating the business than liquidating its individual assets; we judge that to be the case here given the company's diversified end-market exposure and long-tenured customer relationships discussed in our separate surveillance of the issuer credit rating.

Priority claims ahead of this facility's own recovery in the simulated default scenario include administrative claims and any secured term loan borrowings ranking pari passu with this facility under the credit agreement's own intercreditor terms; the mandatory sinking fund obligations under the municipal conduit financing continue to be serviced by the corporate guarantee in our simulated default scenario and do not compete with this facility for collateral proceeds, consistent with that guarantee's own unconditional terms.

After deducting the priority claims described above from our going-concern valuation, we estimate net recovery value available to this facility, given its first-priority security interest, sufficient to support recovery prospects in the 90%-100% range - the highest Recovery Rating category our scale provides ('1') - across a reasonable range of assumptions for the going-concern multiple itself.

Comparable transactions

We have observed a number of similarly structured sponsor-led acquisitions of single-B rated diversified manufacturing issuers over the past several years, in which the target's existing secured revolving credit facility was amended and extended at closing rather than refinanced in full, with the facility's own collateral package and covenant structure carried forward largely unchanged. In several of those precedent transactions, the surviving facility's issue-level rating was affirmed even where the issuer credit rating itself was lowered, because the facility's own Recovery Rating and notching uplift were unaffected by the increase in secured debt; in others, a material increase in secured debt ranking alongside the facility did weaken its Recovery Rating and narrow or eliminate the uplift.

Which of those two precedent patterns this facility follows, if the pending transaction closes, will depend on the amount and ranking of any incremental secured debt the sponsor's own financing structure introduces, not on the issuer credit rating outcome alone; we discuss that sensitivity under Downside scenario above and under Recovery Rating: 1 earlier in this report.

Analyst commentary on sponsor financing structure

Sponsor-led acquisitions of issuers of this general size and rating category typically finance a meaningful portion of purchase price through incremental secured debt raised alongside, or in place of, an amended existing secured facility, reflecting a financial sponsor's typical use of leverage relative to a strategic acquirer. We would look for the sponsor's own publicly disclosed sources-and-uses of funds, once available, as the direct input into both our issuer-level Financial Policy modifier and this facility's own recovery analysis, rather than assuming a financing structure based on sector precedent alone.

We note, as we do throughout this report, that our analysis of the pending transaction rests entirely on information the company, the sponsor, or their advisors have made public, together with our own independent credit analysis; we have not been party to, and do not rely on, any non-public negotiation between the parties in connection with the pending transaction.

Liquidity sources and uses

Primary liquidity sources available to the company consist of cash on hand, internally generated cash flow from operations, and availability under this facility. Primary uses of liquidity consist of scheduled interest payments on this facility and the company's other funded debt, maintenance capital expenditure, and ordinary-course working-capital investment. We estimate sources exceed uses by a comfortable margin under our current base-case assumptions, independent of the pending change-of-control transaction discussed throughout this report.

We would revise this Adequate liquidity assessment if the company's own compliance certifications began to show narrowing headroom on the credit agreement's own covenant-defined basis beyond what the Historical covenant headroom trend table above shows, or if utilization under this facility increased materially without a corresponding increase in internally generated cash flow.

Legal and regulatory considerations

We are not aware of any pending environmental remediation obligation, regulatory enforcement action, or material litigation involving the company that we would treat as a distinct driver of this facility's own rating, separate from the Environmental and Social issuer-profile considerations discussed in the ESG considerations section above. Our surveillance of this rating would revisit that conclusion promptly if new public disclosure warranted it.

This facility's own credit agreement includes customary representations, covenants, and events of default for a secured revolving credit facility of this kind; we do not separately opine on the credit agreement's own legal enforceability, which is a matter for the parties' own counsel rather than for this rating.

Collateral and valuation summary (recovery analysis exhibit)

The table below summarizes, at a high level, the collateral categories our going-concern valuation in the Extended recovery analysis section above draws on, and our qualitative assessment of realizability for each category in a simulated default scenario. It is presented for reference and does not itself change the Recovery Rating conclusion stated above.

Collateral category	Realizability in a going-concern	Notes

	sale	
Real property (principal manufacturing facility)	High	Long-tenured facility; also partially financed through the municipal conduit structure discussed elsewhere in our surveillance
Machinery and equipment	High	Specialized to the company's own manufacturing processes but broadly usable by a going-concern acquirer in the same sector
Inventory	Moderate	Subject to ordinary-course valuation haircuts typical of a manufacturing inventory base
Accounts receivable	High	Diversified customer base limits concentration risk in a going-concern realization
Intangibles (customer relationships, trade names)	Moderate	Value is realized primarily through continued operation rather than separate sale

The going-concern approach we apply values the collateral base as a single operating enterprise rather than summing separate liquidation values for each category above; the table is intended only to communicate which categories we view as most and least readily realizable, which informs our qualitative judgment alongside the EBITDA-multiple valuation approach described earlier in this section.

Rating sensitivities — additional detail

The upgrade and downgrade factors listed under Rating Action above apply, in the first instance, to our issuer credit rating on the company; because this facility's own issue-level rating is derived from the issuer credit rating plus a fixed notching uplift tied to its Recovery Rating, a change in either input can move this facility's own rating. An issuer-credit-rating upgrade with an unchanged Recovery Rating of '1' would move this facility's rating up by the same number of notches; a Recovery Rating downgrade to '2' with an unchanged issuer credit rating would narrow this facility's own notching uplift by one notch even absent any change to the issuer credit rating itself.

We would treat a material, publicly disclosed increase in secured debt ranking alongside this facility - for example, the incremental secured term loan discussed under Downside scenario above, if disclosed on terms larger than currently contemplated - as a trigger to revisit the Recovery Rating specifically, independent of our regular surveillance cycle for the issuer credit rating.

We would also revisit this facility's own rating, outside our regular surveillance cycle, if the credit agreement were amended in a way that materially narrowed the facility's own first-priority collateral package, independent of any change in the amount of secured debt outstanding under the facility itself.

None of the sensitivities discussed above should be read as a commitment to take a specific rating action on a specific timetable; each remains subject to our full analytical review at the time any triggering event, if it occurs, is disclosed, consistent with our general surveillance practice for a facility rating of this kind and with our regular monitoring cadence for issuers carrying a Negative outlook.

Appendix: Ratio definitions

This appendix sets out how S&P Global Ratings arrives at the adjusted figures carried in the Key Indicators exhibit above and referenced elsewhere in this report. These are the standard definitions S&P Global Ratings applies across its surveillance of the broader rated universe in this sector - none of them has been customized to this issuer, and a reader should not infer issuer-specific tailoring from any of the seven definitions that follow.

Coverage ratio and (CFO minus capital expenditures)/Debt are the two cash-flow-based measures used elsewhere in this report. Coverage ratio relates adjusted cash flow (funds from operations plus cash interest expense, or an analogous measure) to cash interest expense, testing an issuer's capacity to service interest from ongoing operations without resort to refinancing; (CFO minus capital expenditures)/Debt relates cash flow from operations, net of capital expenditures, to adjusted gross debt (defined below), testing an issuer's capacity to delever organically absent an asset sale, refinancing, or equity contribution.

Turning to the debt and EBITDA measures underlying the leverage ratio: S&P Global Ratings-adjusted gross debt captures funded debt plus capitalized operating leases (added at our own standard capitalization multiple on annual lease expense) plus the principal of any municipal conduit or other guaranteed financing the issuer's own credit agreement treats as funded indebtedness - unlike a bank-covenant test, this figure is never reduced by unrestricted cash, which the Key Indicators exhibit instead presents separately under Liquidity.

S&P Global Ratings-adjusted EBITDA, the other half of the leverage ratio, is reported EBITDA adjusted for the standard analytical items {agency} applies, including its own treatment of non-recurring items evidenced in trailing results - but this figure specifically EXCLUDES any credit for management-projected run-rate cost savings or revenue synergies not yet realized in reported results, a deliberate divergence from a typical credit-agreement EBITDA definition, which may allow such credit subject to its own contractual caps and conditions; the two are not interchangeable.

S&P Global Ratings-adjusted Debt/EBITDA divides the gross debt figure above by the EBITDA figure above; being gross (not net of cash) and lease-capitalized, it will typically read higher than the issuer's own credit-agreement-defined, cash-netted leverage ratio under that agreement's own terms - the two should not be treated as the same quantity computed two ways, nor expected to converge even when both are computed correctly.

S&P Global Ratings-adjusted EBITDA margin follows directly: S&P Global Ratings-adjusted EBITDA, as defined above, divided by net revenue for the same period.

A closing point applicable to every definition above: none of them changes, restates, or should be read together with any defined term in the issuer's own credit agreement, indenture, or other financing document. Those documents' own defined terms govern for every purpose under those documents, covenant compliance included, and this appendix does not purport to interpret them.

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